A FREE GUIDE FROM ORLA MARIE

Five simple mindfulness *practices for everyday life*

Mindfulness is simply paying attention to the present moment, on purpose and without judgement. You don't need special equipment or a lot of time. These five practices take from one to five minutes and fit into an ordinary day.

1

Three mindful breaths 1 MINUTE

Wherever you are, pause. Breathe in and feel the air coming in. Breathe out and feel your body soften a little. Do this three times. Use it before a meeting, a difficult phone call, or when you first wake.

2

Feet on the floor 1 MINUTE

Notice the contact of your feet with the ground. Feel the weight of your body supported by the chair or the floor beneath you. When thoughts are racing or feelings are strong, this is a steady place to come back to.

3

A mindful cup of tea 5 MINUTES

Make your tea or coffee and, just this once, do nothing else. Feel the warmth of the cup in your hands, notice the colour, the smell and the first taste. When your mind wanders, which it will, gently come back to the cup.

4

S.T.O.P. 2 MINUTES

Stop what you are doing. **T**ake a breath. **O**bserve what is here: thoughts, feelings, sensations in the body. **P**roceed, choosing what to do next rather than running on autopilot. Helpful whenever you feel rushed or overwhelmed.

5

Three good things 3 MINUTES, AT BEDTIME

Before sleep, bring to mind three things from the day that were good, however small: a kind word, a moment of sunshine, a cup of tea. Let yourself rest with each one for a few breaths.

Go gently

You are always in charge of your practice. Keep your eyes open if you prefer, move whenever you need to, and stop at any time. If a practice brings up anything difficult, it's fine to simply open your eyes, notice the room around you and come back another day. Mindfulness is not a substitute for medical or psychological care.

"Mindfulness isn't about emptying the mind. It's about meeting each moment as it is."

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